



The Garamut "The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'! **For PRAYER, PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
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IN YOUR JOURNEY FORWARD INTO THE FUTURE, WE **WILL REQUIRE FAITH!**

- This will require the constant presence of trusting God.
- FAITH! is our way of expressing our DEPENDENCY upon God.
- FAITH WILL **BE REQUIRED IF WE ARE TO TRAVERSE THE PATHWAY** that God has laid out for us.
- FAITH **MUST NEVER BE LEFT BEHIND** – it must always be present.
- FAITH IS REQUIRED for the entire journey to which we are called – culminating only in death.
- GENUINE FAITH HAS NO **SUBSTITUTES**, even though there are many counterfeits, look a-likes, copies.

1. The **SOURCE OF FAITH** – it comes from God
 - FAITH comes from the **hearing** of the Word of God.
 - FAITH comes from **exercising** faith.
 - FAITH comes from **fellowshipping** with faith people.
2. THE **INFUSION OF FAITH** – it comes from "hearing" God's Word
 - "hearing" means listening and application.
 - IT IS THE HEART THAT IS **INFUSED / FILLED** WITH FAITH as a result of **applying The WORD of God to the heart**.
 - The **HEART** is the **OBJECTIVE**, - THE **WORD** is the **SOURCE**, - THE **SPIRIT** is the **VEHICLE**
 - **Infusion** is the introduction of something needed: the addition of a new or necessary quality or element to something.
3. THE **POWER OF FAITH!**
 - Faith has power to change circumstances and people's lives.
 - FAITH transforms, completely changing the shape and function of things.
 - FAITH that is living and active causes God to intervene in our world.

Mark 9:23 Jesus said to him, "If you can believe, all things are possible to him who believes." NKJV
*Matthew 17:20 He replied, "Because you have so little faith. I tell you the truth, if you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, 'Move from here to there' and it will move. **Nothing will be impossible for you.**" NIV*
4. **FAITH MUST ALWAYS BE PRESENT** at all times and situations.
 - This means our regular daily program.
 - Faith and the request for God's help in the small things of life as much as it is needed in the bigger things.
 - Remember with God, "Nothing is too small and Nothing too big".
 - Faith is that critical factor that enhances the heart and mind with anticipation and expectancy of what can be accomplished for God.
5. **PERSONAL FAITH** – it must be MY faith – faith that BELONGS to me
 - FAITH must be exercised **INDIVIDUALLY** and **PERSONALLY**.
 - A Faith that I act upon to express my obedience to God's command and my trust and dependency on his promises.
 - My faith and not the faith of another. There are too many that make the mistake of stepping out on another person's faith.
6. **FAITH IS VISIBLE, RECOGNIZABLE, PUBLICLY SEEN**, it is seen by God, and by others looking on.
 - FAITH CAN and MUST be seen.

- FAITH BEGINS in the heart, **but it must be ACTED upon**, for only THEN does it become PUBLIC – where God and others can SEE it.
 - ▶ JESUS SAW people's faith - Mark 2:5 When Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralytic, "Son, your sins are forgiven." NIV
 - ▶ GOD IS ALSO LOOKING FOR FAITH - Luke 18:8 I tell you, he will see that they get justice, and quickly. However, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?" NIV
7. THE ASSERTIVENESS OF FAITH (its forceful behaviour)
- FAITH IS BOLD, CONFIDENT, PERSUASIVE and **not ashamed** to press its claims, according to what God's Word declares.
 - it remains firm that if God said it then that SETTLES it and says "AMEN"
 - It is **PENETRATING** in its expression, even 'BRASSY' AND BRAZEN and sometimes criticized as foolish and unreceptive to prevailing opinions.
8. THE PERSISTENCY OF FAITH.
- * **FAITH CONTINUES** and does not give up on regardless of the circumstances or temptations.
 - * **FAITH PERSISTS** in its PURSUIT of those PURPOSES that have been entrusted to us.
 - * For the person who lives close to God FAITH WILL CONTINUE TO RISE AGAIN AND AGAIN AND FLOOD OUR HEART AND MIND with the amazing possibilities that we can accomplish.
 - * This is also true in the midst of human weakness and there are many things competing for our heart's affections.
9. REMAINING IN FAITH!
- The necessity for each of us to remain in faith and not to depart from it. Not to leave faith behind for something else.
 - This is about **personal faith** not the Christian faith.
 - It is when we deliberately choose to trust God that we are showing our **dependency on** God.
- William Carey (1761-1834) Missionary to India and known as the Father of Modern Missions stated: *I can plod. I can persevere in any definite pursuit. To this I owe everything.* and he also said *"I can plod and persevere. That is my only genius."* NO GENIUS – just faith in God
"If he give me credit for being a plodder he will describe me justly. Anything beyond that will be too much.
- A **PLODDER** is a person who works or moves slowly, steadily, and persistently. While they may lack flashiness, creativity, or speed, they reliably get the job done through sheer effort and determination.
10. THE EXPECTATION OF FAITH
- William Carey also said: *"Expect great things from God; attempt great things for God."*
- THIS EMBRACES TWO DISTINCTIVE THINGS – THE JOINING FAITH WITH BOLD INTENTIONAL ACTION.
 - ▶ **EXPECT GREAT THINGS FROM GOD**
 - OUR FAITH is to be ANCHORED in the divine truth that God is able to do exceedingly above all that we ask of or think (Ephesians 3:20). AND IN our GOD who desires TO SHOW his GRACE, and EXPECTED PROVISION in our everyday life.
 - ▶ **THE ENDEAVORS OF FAITH** - *"attempt great things for God."*
 - MAKING EVERY EFFORT TO DO GREAT THINGS FOR GOD
 - BIG and DARING expectations should motivate bold and daring actions and exploits for those God given purposes including the serving of others.
 - It means taking measured risks and engaging in less comfortable or safe ventures.
 - It means demonstrating a sense of abandonment of one's personal safety for the cause for which Christ died.
11. THE ENVIRONMENT OF FAITH
- ▶ FAITH MUST OPERATE IN THE ENVIRONMENT OF HUMILITY PRACTICED AND A GENUINE DESIRE TO PLEASE GOD - Faith never seeks to promote itself.
 - ▶ FAITH CAN BE **ASSERTIVE, PERSUASIVE AND DETERMINED** BUT NEVER AT THE EXPENSE OF FELLOW BRETHREN, so that brethren are harmed, mistreated or discarded.
 - ▶ **FAITH MUST FUNCTION IN THE CONTEXT OF BROTHERLY LOVE**
 - ▶ FAITH MUST BE PURE IN ITS MOTIVATION - no ulterior or impure reasons
 - ▶ FAITH IT IS TO operate IN AN ATMOSPHERE that is PEACE LOVING, GENTLE, CONSIDERATE SUBMISSIVE.
 - ▶ IN ATMOSPHERE THAT IS FULL OF MERCY AND GOOD FRUIT
 - ▶ FAITH THAT IS IMPARTIAL AND SINCERE
 - ▶ FAITH that operates in a godly environment PRODUCES PEACEMAKERS who ENJOY the HARVEST OF righteousness (RIGHT LIVING)
- James 3:17 *But the wisdom that comes from heaven is first of all pure; then peace-loving, considerate, submissive, full of mercy and good fruit, impartial and sincere. 18 Peacemakers who sow in peace raise a harvest of righteousness. NIV*
- ▶ FAITH MUST OPERATE IN THE CONTEXT OF ALL ASPECTS of the teaching of God's Word and not just some.

Amen Ps Barry